

likely be some practical things, based on an underlying lack of financial literacy or education at the time, but there could also be some deeper learnings about your relationship with money and your financial habits.

Guilt and apologies

Sometimes we make mistakes with money that hurt other people. We borrow it from people we care about but can't or don't pay it back, we hide financial worries from a partner, we make promises that we can't keep. And, while this chapter is heavily focussed on self-forgiveness and overcoming the shame and guilt that accompany financial mistakes, it would be remiss of me to ignore the hurt feelings of those people; firstly, because they are important in their own right, and, secondly, because *you* won't be able to forget them. If there are people who you care about, who you have hurt in some way that relates to money, you will probably struggle to find any real sense of financial wellbeing until you have made amends.

It takes courage to apologize, especially when the issue is something that's as awkward to talk about as money. It's likely that the other person or people don't feel able to bring up the hurt, because confrontation is something that most of us struggle with anyway, and when you pair that with our cultural resistance to talking about money, it's a recipe for brewing resentment and awkwardness. They might also be worrying